

STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE

QA and the Go-Live Gate

How work gets tested, evidenced, and approved

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WHAT THIS IS

This is how a task goes from built to done. It covers the test you run on your own work, the evidence you attach, the review Brad or Cash do, and the one habit that protects every client relationship: verify it as the client would before anyone says it is live. Use it on every task, on every capability, every time.

DONE MEANS

The capability works end to end from the client's side, the evidence is in the task notes and named to the standard, the review checklist passes, and Brad or Cash have moved the task to done.

01 Why the gate exists

One past client churned because we told her things were live that she could not see. Posts were published by the API and returned success, but the app was in development mode so the public never saw them. For two weeks she looked at an empty feed while we said it was working. At the same time the scope grew with every message and there was no paper. The engagement ended. This gate is the fix.

Two ideas run through everything below. First, **our system saying it worked is not the test**. The test is what the client sees. Second, **only Brad or Cash mark a task done**. You move it to review with evidence. They open it as the client and approve it or send it back.



The QC flow. Gold = Brad or Cash decide.

Builder (you)	Brad or Cash	Client
Runs the test script for each capability. Captures evidence. Names and attaches it. Moves the task to review. Fixes and resubmits when sent back.	Run the review checklist. Open the thing as the client. Approve to done, or send back with a reason. The only people who mark done.	Uses the system the way it was built for them. Their experience is the only score that counts. Never a test subject for unproven automation on their live accounts.

Never test in production

Never test or iterate on a client's live accounts or live channels. Use test contacts, test numbers, test URLs and a test domain. A working manual process is never replaced by automation until the automation is proven somewhere safe.

02 The universal definition of done

Every task, no matter how small, is done only when all five are true.

Definition of done, every task

- ☐ It works end to end. Not a piece of it, the whole path from trigger to result.
- ☐ It was tested as the client would use it: their number, their form, their calendar, an incognito browser.
- ☐ Screenshots or a Loom are in the task notes, named to the standard in section 04.
- ☐ The SOP was updated if the task taught us something.
- ☐ The task is moved to review. Brad or Cash mark it done.

Task statuses on the Bench are backlog, in progress, review, blocked, done. Moving to review pings Brad. Moving to blocked asks you for a reason and pings Brad. Nothing goes from in progress to done by your hand.

03 Test scripts by capability

Run the script for each capability in scope. Each script has a pass condition. If any line fails, it is not ready for review. Use a test contact with a phone number you control, and delete or tag it as test when you finish.

Missed call text back

1

Call the client's line from your test phone

Let it ring. Do not answer on the client's side. Hang up or let it go to voicemail.

2

Watch for the text

The text must arrive on your test phone within 60 seconds. Screenshot the text with the timestamp visible.

3

Check the contact

Open the CRM. A contact exists for your number, tagged as a new lead with the right source. Screenshot the contact with tags visible.

4

Pass

Text within 60 seconds, contact created, tagged. All three or it fails.

Web form

1

Submit the form from the live test URL

Use an incognito browser on mobile. Fill in your test name and number. Submit.

2

Check the CRM

The contact exists with the form fields mapped correctly and the source tag set.

3

Check the notification

The internal notification (email or SMS to the client's chosen person) arrived. Screenshot it.

4

Check the follow up

The follow up SMS reached your test phone within 60 seconds. Screenshot with timestamp.

5

Pass

Contact created, notification received, follow up within 60 seconds.

Calendar booking

1

Book from the public link

Open the public booking widget in incognito. Book a slot as your test contact.

2

Confirmation

The confirmation email arrived at your test address. Screenshot it.

3

Reminder scheduled

In the CRM, the reminder workflow shows the contact enrolled with the reminder pending. Screenshot.

4

No double booking

Try to book the same slot again from a second incognito window. It must not be offered. If it is, check availability hours, buffers, connected Google calendar sync and slot interval.

5

Pass

Booked, confirmed, reminder pending, same slot not available a second time.

Voice AI

1

Call the line

Call from your test phone during a time the receptionist should answer. It answers within a few rings and introduces the business correctly.

2

Ask to book

Ask for an appointment. Give a name, a reason and a preferred time. It offers real availability and books.

3

Check the calendar

The appointment lands on the right calendar, at the time agreed, under the right staff member if routed.

4

Check the contact

The contact exists with the details captured and a call summary written as a note. Screenshot the note.

5

Pass

Answered, booked on the right calendar, note on the contact.

Review request

1

Complete a test appointment

Mark the test appointment as completed, or whatever the trigger is in the scope.

2

Trigger fires

The review request message goes out to your test contact at the configured delay. Screenshot with timestamp.

3

Link works

Tap the link on a phone. It opens the client's Google review page for the right business.

4

Pass

Fires after completion, link opens the right review page.

Website

Check	How	Evidence
Mobile and desktop	Open the test URL in incognito on a phone and on a laptop. Every page, top to bottom.	One screenshot per device of the home page, plus any page that broke.
PageSpeed	Run PageSpeed Insights on the test URL, mobile.	Screenshot of the score.
Forms	Submit every form (the web form script above).	Contact screenshot per form.
SSL	The padlock shows and the certificate is valid for the domain. No mixed content warnings.	Screenshot of the padlock or certificate.

Check	How	Evidence
Links	Click every nav link, footer link, phone link and button. Phone links dial. Email links open.	Note in the task: all links checked, plus any you fixed.
Contact details	Phone, address, hours match the asset form exactly.	Note in the task.

Email deliverability

1

Send a test

Send a test email from the client's sending domain in GHSL to a Gmail address you control.

2

Not in spam

It lands in the inbox, not spam or promotions. Screenshot the inbox.

3

SPF and DKIM pass

Open the message headers (show original in Gmail). SPF and DKIM both show pass. Screenshot the header block.

4

From address is the client's

If it arrives from a relay address, the sending domain is not verified. Verify it in Settings, Email Services, then retest.

5

Pass

Inbox, SPF pass, DKIM pass, from the client's domain.

Texts and emails that silently vanish

For US clients, SMS needs A2P 10DLC brand and campaign registration or texts get filtered. Canadian numbers have their own carrier rules. If a text test fails with everything else correct, check registration status before touching the workflow, and tell Brad. Sending domains need SPF, DKIM and warm up.

04 The evidence standard

Evidence is how Brad reviews without redoing your work. Bad evidence is a screenshot of a settings page. Good evidence shows the result from the client's side, with the time on it.

What a good screenshot shows

- The result, not the configuration. The text on the phone, not the workflow that sends it.
- A timestamp, so the 60 second claim can be checked.
- Enough context to know which client and which capability. The business name or number visible.
- Taken from the client's vantage point: incognito, logged out, the test phone.
- No secrets. No tokens, passwords, or agency screens. Crop them out or do not take the screenshot.

What a good Loom shows

- Under three minutes. Start at the trigger, end at the result.
- Say what you are testing in the first sentence.
- Show the clock or timestamps on screen where timing matters.
- Cover the whole path: submit, contact appears, text arrives.

Naming

One name pattern so anyone can find it: `client_capability_check_date`. Examples:
`northshorephysio_missedcall_text_2026-09-10.png`,

northshorephysio_form_contact_2026-09-10.png,
northshorephysio_voiceai_booking_2026-09-10.mp4. Use the client slug from the task, lower case, no spaces.

Where it goes

The task notes on the Bench. Every piece of evidence for a task lives on that task. Not in chat, not in a Loom link with no context, not on your laptop. If Brad cannot find it on the task, it does not exist.

Evidence as you go

Post evidence as you go, one capability at a time, not in one dump at the end. If you get pulled away, the task still shows exactly where you got to.

05 The review checklist Brad uses

This is what Brad or Cash check when the task hits review. Run it yourself first. If you would send it back, so will they.

Review checklist

- ☐ Every scoped item has evidence on the task. No item is described only in words.
- ☐ Each piece of evidence shows the result from the client's side, with a timestamp where timing matters.
- ☐ Opened the test URL or called the line personally, incognito or from a phone, and it behaved as claimed.
- ☐ Timing claims hold: text within 60 seconds, reminders scheduled, no double booking.
- ☐ Every workflow is Published, not draft, and re entry is off unless the scope needs it.
- ☐ Nothing outside the scope sheet was built. Anything extra is logged as a change order.
- ☐ No internal terms in anything client facing: one pager, emails, messages, reports.
- ☐ State file updated the same day as the last config change.
- ☐ SOP updated if the task taught us something, or a note saying it did not.
- ☐ No secrets in screenshots, Looms, notes or repos.

CONFIRM WITH BRAD

Under the Bench rules, review pings Brad and only Brad or Cash mark done. Whether Cash reviews technical work alone or only sales side deliverables is not settled in this doc.

06 Verify before claiming live

VERIFY BEFORE CLAIMING LIVE

Never say live, fixed, posted, or done until you have opened it in an incognito window, logged out, the way the client would, and seen it with your own eyes. Published by the API is not visible to the client. A green status in our system is not the test. If you cannot see it as the client, it is not live, and you say so.

The exact habit

1

Open a fresh incognito window

No logins, no cached session. On a phone, use a browser you are not signed into, or the test phone.

2

Go the way the client would

Type the public URL, search the business on Google, call the public number, tap the link in the text. Not the admin URL, not the preview, not the API response.

3

Look for the actual result

The page renders. The post is on the feed. The text is on the phone. The booking is on the calendar.

4

Only then report it

Write what you saw, where, and when. If it is not there, write that instead, plainly, and keep working.

Why this matters

With a past client, the API returned published for every post while the app sat in development mode. The posts were visible only to us. We told her it was fixed and to trust the process while she looked at an empty feed. It cost the engagement. The fix is not a better API check. The fix is a person opening the feed logged out before anyone says the word live.

Platform pre flight

Before any channel is offered to a client, pre flight it: the platform app is published, business verified, and a test post is visible logged out. If a channel is not ready, keep a manual fallback ready so the client is never stuck waiting on us.

07 What send back means

Send back is not a mark against you. It means the reviewer found a gap between what was claimed and what they could see. It comes with a reason. Your job is to close the gap and resubmit with new evidence.

1

Read the reason first

The send back note says what failed and how the reviewer checked. Reproduce it the same way before you change anything.

2

Fix the cause, not the symptom

If the text arrived in 90 seconds, the fix is in the trigger or the workflow, not in editing the screenshot.

3

Retest the full script

Run the whole capability script again, not only the failed line. Fixes break neighbours.

4

Post new evidence

New screenshots or Loom, new names with today's date. Leave the old ones so the history is visible.

5

Reply on the task and move to review

One short note: what was wrong, what you changed, what you now see. Then review. No message to Brad outside the task unless he asked.

When to stop and ask

Three consecutive send backs on the same task is a signal to stop and talk to Brad before the fourth attempt. Something in the scope or the setup is wrong, and another try will not fix it.

08 Definition of done

Definition of done

- ☐ Every capability in scope ran its full test script and passed.
- ☐ Evidence for each capability is on the task, named to the standard, showing the result from the client's side.
- ☐ Everything claimed live was opened incognito, logged out, as the client would, and seen.
- ☐ Review checklist in section 05 self checked and passing.
- ☐ State file updated today. SOP updated if we learned something.
- ☐ No test contacts left untagged in the client's CRM.
- ☐ Task moved to review. Brad or Cash marked it done.

09 When it goes wrong

Symptom	First three checks	Who to tell
Text never arrives on the test phone	1. Workflow Published, not draft. 2. Contact's workflow enrollment history. 3. SMS registration status for the number (A2P 10DLC in the US).	Brad if it is registration or the number. Otherwise fix and retest.
Text arrives twice	1. Allow re entry setting on the workflow. 2. Two workflows on the same trigger. 3. A manual send racing an automated one.	Fix, retest, note it on the task.
Form submits but no contact	1. Form is wired to GHL by webhook or API, not only the Netlify inbox. 2. The serverless function awaits the CRM write before returning. 3. Field mapping and required fields.	Fix. Brad if the site was built by someone else.
Double booking on the calendar	1. Availability hours and buffers. 2. Connected Google calendar sync. 3. Slot interval.	Fix, retest with two incognito windows.
Voice AI books on the wrong calendar	1. Calendar assigned in the agent config. 2. Which calendar the booking landed on and why. 3. Staff routing rules.	Fix. Brad if the agent config needs a sub account PIT you do not have.
Email lands in spam or from a relay address	1. Sending domain verified in Settings, Email Services. 2. SPF and DKIM records at the registrar. 3. Domain warm up state.	Brad if DNS access is needed.
Site works for you but not the client	1. Open it incognito on a phone. 2. DNS and SSL for the exact domain they typed. 3. Cached old version on their side.	Do not say it is live until you see it their way. Brad if DNS.
Reviewer sees something different from your screenshot	1. Reproduce exactly the way the reviewer did. 2. Were you logged in when you tested. 3. Has anything changed since the screenshot.	Reply on the task with what you found.
Client reports it is broken after approval	1. Reproduce as the client. 2. Enrollment history and recent config changes. 3. State file versus what is in the sub account.	Brad immediately. Own it plainly with the client, never say trust the process.